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Assignment Instructions:

Communication Challenge #1: Finding and Telling a Narrative from Data

For this challenge, you will demonstrate your ability to present results from a data analysis in a [three-minute story](#):

"The 3-minute story is exactly what it sounds like: If you had only three minutes to tell your audience what they need to know: what would that sound like? This is a great way to ensure you are clear on and can articulate the story you want to tell." (Knaflie)

Your story should clearly emphasize a simple narrative from the data.

Scenario & Receiver(s): The leadership team of the National Automobile Dealers Association ([NADA](#)) has asked you for a fresh interpretation of the attached dataset (Bureau of Economic Analysis's Auto and Light Truck Sales Data). NADA's leaders are particularly interested in outside perspectives and potential narratives (positive or negative) that can be told from the attached data.

Specifics:

1. Review and analyze the attached dataset (BEA Auto-Light Truck Sales.xlsx)

2. Identify a simple story within the data; you need not make use of all the data

Month	Year	Domestic_Autos	Foreign_Autos	Date	Total_Auto_Sales	Total_Truck_Sales	Truck_Dominates
94	November 1997	463.3	95.2	1997-11-01	558.5	559.3	True
106	November 1998	457.9	98.0	1998-11-01	555.9	585.2	True
108	January 1999	440.0	103.5	1999-01-01	543.5	547.2	True
118	November 1999	491.9	141.4	1999-11-01	633.3	642.5	True
119	December 1999	526.1	147.9	1999-12-01	674.0	721.4	True

The Gap widens between truck and auto sales for years after

Month	Year	Domestic_Autos	Foreign_Autos	Date	Total_Auto_Sales	Total_Truck_Sales	Gap widens.
94	November 1997	463.3	95.2	1997-11-01	558.5	559.3	True 0.8
106	November 1998	457.9	98.0	1998-11-01	555.9	585.2	True 29.3
108	January 1999	440.0	103.5	1999-01-01	543.5	547.2	True 3.7
118	November 1999	491.9	141.4	1999-11-01	633.3	642.5	True 9.2
119	December 1999	526.1	147.9	1999-12-01	674.0	721.4	True 47.4

3. Present this story following a traditional narrative arc (exposition, conflict, climax, resolution). Among other things, you may consider: What makes your narrative compelling? How does the data support it? How would it be received?

Exposition

- In the early '90s, it's easy to see that autos sales were on top of truck sales and were staying there with consistently leading sales.
- Light trucks sales are there but it's clear that Americans preferred passenger cars over trucks at this time.

Conflict

- After the late 90's, you notice a shift in the graph where truck sales are rising to where auto sales are. Auto sales are even beginning to dip at this point.
- The gap between auto sales and truck sales is becoming increasingly smaller where it becomes difficult to tell in the graph which one is leading in sales.

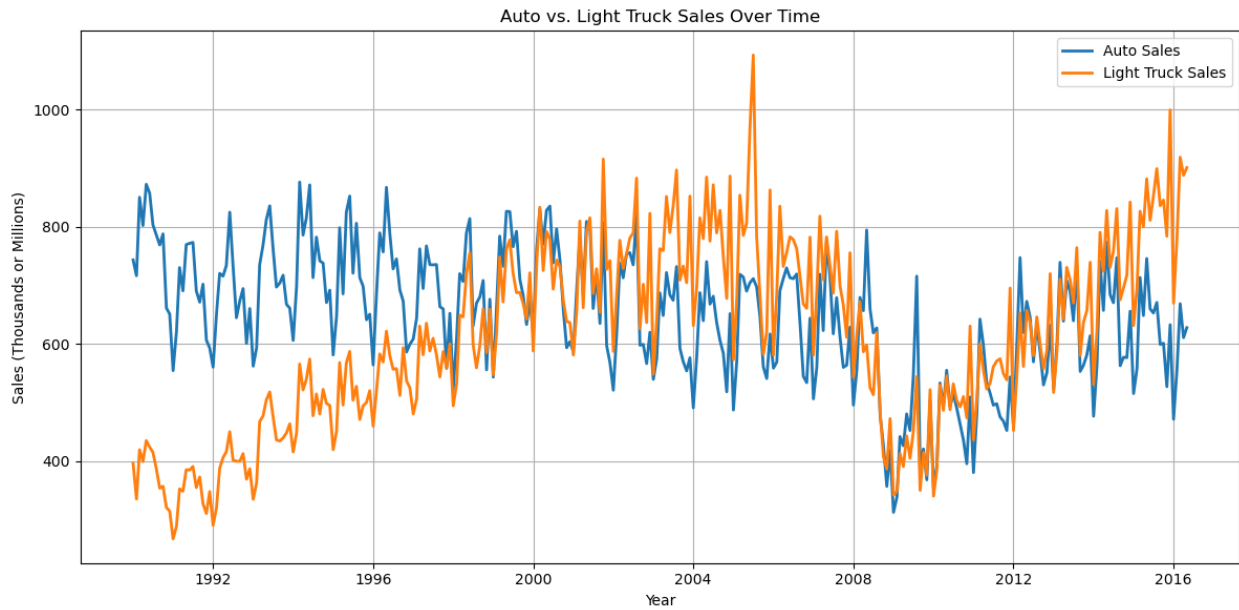
Climax

- Then in **November 1997**, the lines finally crossed. Light truck sales pulled ahead of auto sales for the first time.
- From November 1997 the gap between auto sales and truck sales begins to consistently widen in favor of truck sales. This shows a trend where Americans are beginning to favor trucks over cars and not a one-month fluke.

Resolution

- From November 1997, the gap between truck sales and auto sales consistently widens every year thereafter. This shows a trend where Americans are moving away from passenger cars in favor of light trucks.

3. Develop and include appropriate visual support (charts, graphs, etc.). Only what you need to help tell this story.



Submission:

Submit your written three-minute story and include at least one data visualization in the document. Length will vary -- again, imagine you have three minutes to deliver your story.

Evaluation:

Holistic evaluation will be assessed based on the criteria outlined above and the quality of the narrative presented.